

DIEGO URZÚA ESCOBAR

Innovation & Entrepreneurship · Applied Education Research · Digital Product & AI-Assisted Web Development

Portfolio: diegourzua.com

Santiago, Chile · +56 9 5688 1664 · durzs@uc.cl · linkedin.com/in/durzs

PROFILE

Psychologist with a Master's in Educational Psychology (Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile) combining applied education research, innovation management and digital product development. Four years in university research (FONDECYT projects and a UC laboratory), focused on AI-assisted educational assessment. Co-founder of AprendeLocal SpA, an edtech company for rural schools in Chile and Brazil, recognized in innovation competitions in China, Brazil and Chile and covered by national and international media. I build production web applications (frontend, backend and databases) through AI-assisted development.

RESEARCH AND TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Thesis Researcher — FONDECYT No. 1251102, Faculty of Social Sciences, UC

2025 – 2026

- Developed an educational assessment methodology based on locally run artificial intelligence models, designed to protect data privacy and to enable use in low-resource settings.
- Master's thesis approved (2026), deposited in the UC institutional repository: repositorio.uc.cl/handle/11534/111911
- Supervisor: Prof. Katherine Strasser, Dean of the Faculty of Social Sciences, UC.

Research Intern — FONDECYT No. 1231550, Faculty of Education, UC

2025

- Supported data collection, processing and analysis in a project on language development and teaching practices. Supervisor: Dr. Susana Mendive.

Research Intern — Universidad Austral, Argentina (HUC Internship Program)

Aug 2023 – Apr 2024

- Remote participation in the Parenting Stress Project, as part of the Hemispheric University Consortium internship program.

Research Assistant — Language, Interaction and Phenomenology Laboratory (LIFLab), UC

2022 – 2024

- Coding and analysis of interaction data, literature review and support in preparing research materials.

Teaching Assistant — School of Psychology, UC

2024 – 2025

- Teaching assistant for two consecutive years in "Theories of Cognition" and "Intelligence, Thought and Language", and in "Oral and Written Language Development": teaching support, leading practical sessions and giving feedback to students.

Academic Engagement

- Thesis results seminar for researchers at the MISTRALL Millennium Institute (Literacy and Transformative Learning), 2026.
- CIEDS 2026 Congress, Villarrica, Chile — confirmed participation (October 2026).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Co-founder — AprendeLocal SpA (Chile)

Jul 2025 – Present

Company incorporated in Chile, with partners in Brazil · Validation stage, pre-revenue

- Co-founded a science education platform for rural schools in Chile and Brazil, designed around place-based learning and built to work in low-connectivity settings.
- Responsible for platform design and development: progressive web app (PWA) with geolocated content and a Supabase database.
- Built a binational Chile–Brazil team and applied to international acceleration and innovation programs.
- Results: three international awards, participation in Rio Innovation Week and national and international press coverage. No formal sales at the close of the period.

Independent Web Development — Own and Client Projects

Mar 2026 – Present

- Design and development of complete websites and web applications (frontend, backend, authentication and database) through AI-assisted development (Claude Code, Antigravity).
- Requirements gathering, production deployment and maintenance. See "Digital Projects" section.

Learning & Training Coordinator — El Ecosistema Startup

Aug 2025 – Mar 2026

- Design, coordination and delivery of support and training programs for entrepreneurs: courses, advisory sessions and workshops.
- Coordination with mentors, speakers and external providers to structure content around entrepreneurs' needs.
- Application of agile methodologies (Design Thinking, Lean Startup) in supporting entrepreneurs.
- Management of administrative and financial processes (contracts and vendor payments) and tracking through management platforms (Notion, Asana, Trello, Monday).

Instructional Design Intern — SWARMOB

Aug 2024 – Apr 2025

- Designed a training system based on active methodologies (Project-Based Learning) as a service offering.
- Iterated the product based on user testing and usability improvement proposals.

Professional Internship in Educational Psychology — Escuela Antumalal, Quinta Normal

Mar 2024 – Jul 2024

- Team design of a project to strengthen family–school relationships: information gathering, interviews with key stakeholders and project design methodologies.

DIGITAL PROJECTS AND WEB DEVELOPMENT

Production web applications, developed end to end with AI assistance (Claude Code, Antigravity).

- aprendelocal.com — AprendeLocal SpA platform. PWA with geolocated educational content, Supabase database and low-connectivity support.
- xuexiclub.cl — Website for Club Xuexi UC. Built the user and membership system, event management and Firebase integration.
- rolanclases.com — Client project: platform for selling and booking private classes, with three-step scheduling and pricing by format and group size.

- diegourzua.com — Professional portfolio: research, projects and teaching experience.

INNOVATION AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

1st Place — Challengers, National Entrepreneurship Competition	2026
Universidad de los Andes, Chile. Solved a real-world challenge and presented the solution in a pitch to a jury; first place nationwide, with press coverage.	
Bronze Award (finalist) — China–LatAm Challenge, Tsinghua University	2026
Awarded for the EcoCycle project. The prize includes an on-site internship at Tsinghua University (2027).	
Bronze Award (finalist) — China–LatAm Challenge, Tsinghua University	2025
Awarded for the project that gave rise to AprendeLocal. The prize included an on-site internship in Beijing and Nanjing, China (January 2026).	
Finalist — Innovation Prize, Federal University of Rio de Janeiro (UFRJ)	2025
Finalist with AprendeLocal and participation in Rio Innovation Week, Brazil.	
1st Place — International Innovation Competition	2022
UC Chile · Tec de Monterrey · Uniandes Colombia. Co-designed the value proposition and implementation model for a social-emotional intelligence video game, in an inter-university team.	

MEDIA

- Radio Cooperativa (2026) — interview with the winning team of Challengers, National Entrepreneurship Competition. [Watch interview \(min. 11:46\)](#)
- UC School of Psychology (May 2026) — "China's top university highlights a UC Psychology alumnus's project bringing science to isolated schools" (in Spanish). [Read article](#)
- Xinhua / Tsinghua LAC Center (February 2026) — "Latin American Youth Learn About China's Poverty Alleviation Experience"; statements quoted. [Read article](#)
- CGTN en Español (January 2026) — coverage of the study tour on poverty reduction in China, with participant interviews. [Read article](#)

EDUCATION

Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile	Santiago, Chile
• Master's in Educational Psychology — 2026 • Professional Degree in Psychology, Educational Psychology track — 2025 • B.A. in Psychology — 2024 • B.A. in Social Sciences — 2023	

VOLUNTEERING

External Relations Coordinator and Reading Club Coordinator — Club Xuexi UC	Apr 2026 – Present
• Coordinating ties with external organizations and leading the reading club of a student club devoted to sharing Chinese culture.	
Volunteer, PALLQA UC program — ATD Fourth World, Cusco and Cuyo Grande (Peru)	Jan 2024 – Feb 2024
• On-site volunteering at the "Festival of Knowledge": playful educational workshops for children and adolescents living in poverty.	
Volunteer, Human Resources Lead — Fundación Comisiones Futuro	Dec 2020 – Mar 2022
• Recruitment, selection and coordination of a volunteer team at a STEAM science outreach organization (foundation now dissolved).	

ADDITIONAL AND INTERNATIONAL TRAINING

- Microsoft Azure AI Fundamentals — Microsoft (2025).
- Huawei Seeds for the Future — Huawei Chile (2023–2024).
- U21 Global Citizens — Universitas 21 (2023).
- HUC Social Ideas Challenge — Hemispheric University Consortium (2023).

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Research: research design, quantitative and qualitative analysis, educational assessment; R, SPSS, Excel; applied use of language models.

Web development: full applications (frontend, backend, authentication); Supabase, Firebase; PWA; production deployment; AI-assisted development (Claude Code, Antigravity).

Innovation & entrepreneurship: Design Thinking, Lean Startup, Project-Based Learning; training program design; pitching to national and international juries.

Management & tools: Figma; Canva (advanced); Microsoft Office and Google Workspace.

Languages: Spanish (native); English (B2, IELTS 6.0, 2025); basic Mandarin (A2, HSK 2, 2024).